

Continue the Story

DIFFICULT PRACTICE

READ THE EXTRACT

The letter had been propped against the fruit bowl for three days, and by Thursday morning everyone in the house had walked past it so many times that not looking at it had become its own kind of habit. Priti's mother said nothing over breakfast, only refilled the kettle twice when once would have done. Her father left for work ten minutes earlier than usual, keys jangling like he had somewhere urgent to be, though Priti knew for a fact his first meeting wasn't until half past nine. Nobody had said the word "results" out loud in a week. By the time the front door clicked shut behind him, Priti was alone in the kitchen with the letter, and the house had gone very quiet.

The extract finishes with Priti alone in the kitchen with the letter. Continue the story, in which you explain what's inside, what she decides to do, and what this moment reveals about how her family copes under pressure.

- What's inside the letter, and whether it matches what everyone seemed to fear
- How the quiet of the house shapes the mood of the scene
- Both dialogue and description, if another family member returns
- What this moment reveals about Priti or her family — don't just state it, show it

TECHNIQUES REQUIRED

Subtext — imply more than you state directly	REQUIRED
Action sentences ×3	REQUIRED
Sensory detail across 2+ senses ×2	REQUIRED
Semicolons ×2, colons ×2	REQUIRED
One-sentence paragraph for impact ×1	REQUIRED
A genuine, resolved ending	REQUIRED

YOUR WRITING

CHECKLIST — GO OVER IT AGAIN

1. **Read it all out loud first.**
2. Dialogue tags — "asked" / "he" / "she" after speech: lower case, not capital.
3. New sentence inside speech marks — starts with a capital. No full stop before "and."
4. Was / were — check it matches a singular or plural subject.
5. Every sentence has a verb.
6. No word repeated in the same sentence or the one right after it — swap for a synonym.
7. At least 3 different sentence openers used — not three sentences in a row starting with "He" / "She" / "The."
8. **Ending is finished** — not notes, not cut off mid-action.

